

	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 - Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	O - Disaster Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (DSNAP)
	Section No./Name	O-300-DSNAP Application Process
	Document No./Name	O-330-DSNAP Processing Standards and Office Procedures
	Effective Date	December 1, 2023

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

To the maximum extent possible, applicant households must have their eligibility determined on the day of application or as soon thereafter as possible. ***

Ideally, the household should be able to access DSNAP benefits on the day following the day of application, but DSNAP benefits must be made available to the household no later than the third calendar day following the application date except in questionable cases where issuance may be delayed up to * seven ** days from the date the application was filed.

If more information is needed and requested of the household, DSNAP benefits must be made available to the household no later than the third calendar day following receipt of this information.

*** * A form [DIS 13 – Disaster SNAP Notice of Decision](#) must be given to each applicant once eligibility has been determined.

Previous Online DSNAP registrations submitted will be accessed by DCFS Staff through the DSNAP Worker Portal. The application date is the day the application is entered on the DSNAP Worker Portal and will be populated automatically. In the event that an applicant is applying in person at a local parish office or a designated DSNAP site and the DSNAP Worker Portal is unavailable, the household applies using the paper application. The household information on the paper application is entered in the DSNAP Worker Portal.

In the event that an applicant is applying in person and the DSNAP Worker Portal is unavailable, the household must apply using the paper Application for Disaster Supplemental Nutrition Assistance, [DIS 1](#). If the applicant speaks Spanish or Vietnamese, The [DIS 1SP](#) or [DIS 1VN](#) must be used. The household information on the paper application must be entered into the DSNAP Worker Portal as soon as the system is available. **

* If a DSNAP applicant was previously denied DSNAP benefits for the same disaster, a new eligibility determination is completed with consideration given to the reason for the previous denial. The application is reviewed and must be approved by a member of the Quality Assurance Team prior to certification. **

O-331-DSNAP - PO * Reserved **

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O-333-DSNAP – PO PROCEDURES FOR *** DSNAP APPLICATIONS

Once logged in to the DSNAP Worker Portal, users are navigated to a **Home** screen to select the disaster and disaster site location that they are currently assigned. Only active disasters are displayed in the **Disaster** drop-down list, and only disaster sites that are set up to the selected **Disaster** will display in the **Disaster Site** drop-down list.

The Main Navigation Bar consists of three constant navigation tabs, the Search Household, Households, and DSNAP Cases. Clicking on * the **Search Household** tab navigates the user to the **Search Household** screen. The **Search Household** screen allows the user to search for a person or case in the DSNAP Worker Portal. The user enters the search criteria based on information provided by the client. While the fields are not mandatory, users must enter at least the **Driver's License/State ID, SSN, or Last Name** and at least one character of the **First Name, or Last Name and DOB, or the Case Reference**.

- If no results are found, the following message displays: *No matching records found. Please refine your search*
- If search results are found and the correct client is listed, click the **Reference Number** to open and review/update the **Household Record**.
- If the client had participated in a past DSNAP, then the user is navigated to the **Household Record**, not the **New Household** pop-up screen.
 - The **Household Record** is a snapshot of the information entered from past applications. The information must be reviewed with the applicant during the course of the DSNAP interview and updated as needed to reflect the current situation of the household.
 - From the **Household Record**, the user must validate the Household members' SSNs, and then proceed to add the **Income, Resources, Interviewee**, and then create the new DSNAP case.
- If no search results are found, click **Create New Registration** to register a new household. The **New Household** pop-up screen displays.

Workers must collect the most recent household information from the client and complete the **Household Details** screen.

The **Household Details** screen must be completed prior to creating a DSNAP Case. The **New Household** pop-up screen allows the user to create a new **Household Record** if registering a new client. The **Household Details** screen is complete when a worker ensures that all household members names are spelled correctly, DOB/SSNs are validated, an MPI search has been ran to

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check if the HH members are already receiving benefits, earned/unearned income is current and accurate, and resources are correct. **

* Complete each section of the **New Household** pop-up screen with information provided by the client. Note that some fields have a red asterisk * indicating they are mandatory. The mandatory fields may shift based on responses to certain questions.

The worker must verify the identity of the Interviewee. If the Interviewee is an Authorized Representative, the Head of Household must be. This can be done electronically in three ways: LA Wallet, Office of Motor Vehicle, or SOLQ-I.

NOTE: The LA Wallet and OMV electronic verification provides verification of an individual's identity and residency based on the information available to OMV (as it appears on an individual's drivers' license). If the Driver's License is expired, it cannot be used to verify residency. The SOLQ-I verification cannot be used to verify residency.

This lookup should be used for the Interviewee. If the AR is the Interviewee, this lookup must also be used for the Head of Household in the DSNAP Case.

If unable to verify identity by either of these sources (LA Wallet, OMV, or SOLQ-I), another source must be selected from the **Document** drop-down menu to proceed. If there are no applicable document types to verify the identity of the interviewee and/or head of household, the worker must select **Pending** from the **Document** drop-down menu.

NOTE: A DSNAP Case cannot be approved when the identity **Document** is **Pending**, but the interview should still be completed and the case denied at the end until identity can be verified.

Once the household information has been reviewed, all Income and Resources have been added, the identity of the Interviewee and each Household Member has either an SSN or Pseudo SSN, a DSNAP case can be created for that household for the specific disaster.

On the **Household Record** screen, click the **Arrow** next to the **New Household Income** button and select **New DSNAP Case**. Once a DSNAP Case is created, any updates/changes will not transfer from the **Household Record** to the **DSNAP Case**. After creating the new DSNAP case, the **DSNAP Case Record ID** generates on the **Household Record** screen in the **DSNAP Cases (X)** section. Users can use the **DSNAP Case Record ID** hyperlink to quickly navigate to the **DSNAP Case Record** screen from the **Household Record** screen. **

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* Address Verification

The client's mailing address must be verified before the DSNAP case can be certified. To validate the address, the worker selects the arrow next to **New Case Income** and select **Address Verification**. The worker has the ability to use the data returned from Smarty Streets or proceed with the address entered.

EBT Type

Before certifying the DSNAP case, the EBT Type field must be completed to indicate how the EBT card will be issued to the applicant. From the **DSNAP Case Record – Details** screen, the worker must the **Edit button** to edit the DSNAP Case. In this pop up screen, the worker will select the option **Virtual**, if the client is applying virtually and wishes their card to be mailed to the address that was verified, or **Over the Counter**, if the client is applying in person or virtually and wishes to pick up their card at a DSNAP Site.

Voter Registration

The **DSNAP Case Record - Voter Registration** tab contains questions about voter registration that must be cleared with the client before the case DSNAP case can be certified. Review the two questions asked on the **Voter Registration** screen and enter their response in the Comments/Remarks text box, if applicable and click 'Save'.

Disaster Impact

The **Disaster Impact** screen contains questions pertaining to the disaster impact. Eligibility is determined based on income, resources, expenses, and disaster impact. Document the applicant's statement regarding loss or damage and additional disaster-related expenses, if necessary. The household must have experienced a minimum of \$100 in unreimbursed disaster related expenses in order to qualify for the Standard Disaster Expense Deduction. Enter the amount of disaster expenses in the **Unreimbursed Disaster Related Expenses** option at the bottom ** of the **Disaster Impact** screen. Select **Save** to continue ***.

* Rights and Responsibilities

All applicants are advised of their rights and responsibilities. Applicants may be given the DSNAP Rights and Responsibilities Flyer (DIS 9) Flyer if interviewed in person or read/played their rights and responsibilities to them prior to the beginning of the interview. A recording of the rights and responsibilities may also be played prior to the beginning of the interview at the beginning of the interview. The applicant is asked if they understand the information and if they are in agreement, the "I have read my rights and responsibilities" checkbox is checked by the worker. **

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* The **DSNAP Case Record – Rights and Responsibilities** screen displays the rights and responsibilities and must be reviewed and signed before a case can be certified for benefits. The **Rights and Responsibilities** screen has three sections:

- Your Rights and Responsibilities
- Applicant’s Signature
- Worker’s Signature

Applicant’s Signature

For virtual interviews, the telephonic signature process is explained to the applicant. When the applicant indicates that they understand the electronic signature process, the worker asks the applicant to “Please state your first and last name to record your signature”. The worker enters the interaction ID of the interview in the signature box.

For in-person interviews, the applicant will need to sign the application using an electronic signature by using a stylus, finger, or mouse. If a required field is left blank, an edit will be displayed to advise the worker that the question is required.

Worker’s Signature

An electronic signature is also provided by the worker completing the DSNAP application **. ***

Certification

* To the maximum extent possible, eligibility is determined for applicant households on the day of application, or as soon thereafter as possible.

Once the **Voter Registration**, **Disaster Impact Details**, and **Rights and Responsibilities** tabs have been reviewed and signed and all Case information is complete, the user can calculate eligibility and certify the DSNAP case. Before and following certification, users can view a **Case Summary**.

To calculate eligibility and certified a DSNAP case, the worker will navigate to the **DSNAP Case Record – Details** screen, click the **Arrow** next to **New Case Income** and select **Calculate Eligibility and Certify Case**. The DSNAP Worker Portal will calculate based on information entered into the case and certify or deny.

- If the case does not meet the disaster requirements, this screen will notify the user that the case has not been certified and the user can use this screen to troubleshoot the certification error.
- If the case meets the certification requirements, a success message reads Case has been certified successfully. **

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EBT Issuance

* If eligibility is determined on the day of application and the applicant applied virtually, the DSNAP EBT card is mailed the following business day or can be picked up at a designated DSNAP EBT site the same day or up to one day after the end of the DSNAP application period, if the applicant chooses. Because of the separation of duties, a separate worker is required to issue the EBT card to the applicant after registration is complete.

If the applicant applied in person at a designated DSNAP site, the DSNAP EBT card will be issued over the counter the same day prior to leaving the DSNAP application site.

DSNAP Benefits are usually loaded on the card the same night eligibility is determined. Otherwise, DSNAP benefits are made available to the household no later than the third calendar day following the application date, except in questionable cases where issuance may be delayed up to seven days from the date the application was filed. If more information is needed and requested of the household, DSNAP benefits are made available to the household no later than the third calendar day following receipt of this information.

The worker who is issuing the EBT card must first search for the case to access the applicant's **Household Details** screen before proceeding to issue the EBT card.

On the **DSNAP Case Record – Details** screen, select the **EBT Card Issuance** tab. **

- * For virtual applicants, DSNAP EBT cards will be mailed to the household. Select **Request EBT Card** and then select **Save**. The **EBT Card** number field will be populated with "EBT Card Issued by Vendor."
- For in person applicants or those picking up their EBT card at a DSNAP Site, the card information must be added to the screen.
 - If the automated card swipe for EBT cards is available, the EBT card must be swiped **after selecting Swipe EBT Card**. The EBT card number will populate in the **EBT Card** field.
 - If the card swipe machine is not available, **the worker must select Manually Enter EBT Card and **** the EBT card number must be entered *******.

Denials

If the household's resources combined with the household's income exceed the DSNAP gross income limit, the household is advised that they are not eligible for DSNAP but that they may be eligible for regular SNAP. The system will NOT deny a the DSNAP case, the worker must deny the DSNAP case if the household is not eligible. A DSNAP case must be denied for the following reasons:

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- Total income and resources exceed DSNAP Program income limits
- Moved out of State
- Residence outside of disaster area
- Already received SNAP benefits
- Other

Once a case is denied, the option to re-open the case if needed is available.

If a DSNAP applicant was previously denied DSNAP benefits for the same disaster, a new eligibility determination must be completed with consideration given to the reason for the previous denial. The application must be reviewed and approved by a member of the Quality Assurance Team prior to certification.

* The DSNAP Notice of Decision (DIS 13) is provided whether the application was approved or denied. It informs the household of the decision made on their DSNAP application, right to an on-sight review of application, right to appeal, and also provides EBT card use training and DSNAP benefit information to eligible households.

II. PROCEDURES

O-331-DSNAP – PR Reserved **

*** **O-332-DSNAP - PR** * Reserved **

*** **O-333-DSNAP - PR PROCEDURES FOR *** DSNAP APPLICATIONS**

Follow procedures in Chapter 5, Part IV., [A-116](#) Disaster Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (DSNAP) Training Manual.

III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

DIS 1 [Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Application for Disaster Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program

* DIS 1 SP [Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Application for Disaster Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program

DIS 1 VN [Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Application for Disaster Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program **

DIS 1A [Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Application for Disaster Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (Standard Disaster Expense)

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DIS 3 [Form](#) / [Instructions](#) - Disaster Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program Denial Notice

DIS 13 [Form](#) / [Instructions](#) – Disaster SNAP Notice of Decision

IV. REFERENCES

Food and Nutrition Act of 2008, as amended

Robert T. Stafford Disaster Relief and Emergency Assistance Act of 1988.

USDA Disaster SNAP Guidance